

MODERN INDIAN HISTORY



MODULE - 42

EVENTS BETWEEN 1940-1947

AUGUST OFFER TO CRIPPS MISSION

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

OUTBREAK OF WORLD WAR

3rd Sep, 1939

WORLD WAR II
BROKE OUT

On the same day British Government of India declared India's support for the war without consulting Indian opinion.

CONGRESS VIEW

Congress **did not like the unilateral action** of the British of drawing India into the war without consulting the Indians.

It **decided to support war effort based on two conditions**

1. **Immediately**, some form of **responsible government** should be established **at the Centre**.
2. After war, a **constituent assembly** to be convened to determine political structure of a free India.

The offer was rejected by Linlithgow, the viceroy.

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

OUTBREAK OF WORLD WAR

CWC RESOLUTION

CWC resolution condemned Fascist aggression.

- (i) India could not be party to a war that is fought in the name of democratic freedom, while that freedom being denied to India;
- (ii) if Britain was fighting for democracy and freedom, it should be proved by ending imperialism in its colonies and establishing full democracy in India;
- (iii) the **government should declare its war aims** soon and, also, as to **how the principles of democracy** were to be applied to India after the war.

The Congress leadership wanted “to give every chance to the viceroy and the British Government”.

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

OUTBREAK OF WORLD WAR

17 Oct, 1939



Viceroy tried to use Muslim league and Princes against congress.

LINLITHGOW MADE A
STATEMENT

1. **Refused to define British war** aims beyond stating that Britain was resisting aggression;
2. Said it would consult “representatives of several communities, parties and interests in India, and the Indian princes” as to **how the Act of 1935 might be modified**
3. Said it would immediately set up a “**consultative committee**” whose **advice could be sought** whenever required.

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

OUTBREAK OF WORLD WAR

23 Oct, 1939

CONGRESS
MINISTRIES HANDED
OVER RESIGNATION

Rejected the viceroy statement as a reiteration of the old imperialist policy and decided not to support the war

Both Viceroy and Jinnah were pleased with their resignation.

22 Dec, 1939

DAY OF DELIVERANCE

Jinnah appealed to Indian Muslims to celebrate Day of deliverance to rejoice the resignation of all members of Congress party.

Mar, 1940

(Lahore session of
Muslim league)

“**Pakistan Resolution**” was passed for “grouping of all geographically contiguous Muslim majority areas into independent state” which called for division of India on religious lines and creation of separate nation.

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

OUTBREAK OF WORLD WAR

January 1940, Linlithgow stated, "Dominion status of Westminster variety, after the war, is the goal of British policy in India".

March 1940



**MAULANA ABUL
KALAM AZAD
(PRESIDENT)**

RAMGARH SESSION

- All agreed that British must be opposed but there was disagreement over the form.
- It was decided to leave the form and timing to Gandhi.

The Congress finally declared at the session that the people of India would not accept anything short of complete independence

"Congress would resort to civil disobedience as soon as the Congress organization is considered fit enough or if circumstances precipitate a crisis."

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

AUGUST OFFER, 1940

War has turned against British, pushing British for conciliation. Congress was ready to compromise asking for letting it form an interim government during the war period. But the government was not interested and came up with its own offer.

8th, Aug 1940

LINLITHGOW

In response issued a statement from Shimla

*Popularly
Known as*

AUGUST OFFER

Why?

To secure congress cooperation for World War-II

Provision

Dominion states as objective for India

In-principle approval was given for Constitution

Constitution making body (constituent assembly; mainly Indians) was to be set-up after war

Expansion of Viceroy executive council by increasing the number of Indians from 7 to 12

A war advisory council to be set-up. Later National Defense Council was set-up

No future constitution without the consent of minorities

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

AUGUST OFFER, 1940

EVALUATION

Dominion status was explicitly offered.

For the first time, right of Indians to frame their constitution was recognized

The Congress demand for a constituent assembly was conceded.

REACTION TO OFFER

CONGRESS - REJECTED

No suggestions for setting up interim government or Provincial National Government

Encouraged anti-congress forces like Muslim League

Nehru said Conception of dominion status for India was as "dead as door nail"

MUSLIM LEAGUE - WELCOMED

Welcomed **Veto assurance** given to the league

But took the stand that it would not be satisfied with anything less than partition of India.

British however went ahead with its implementation and accordingly viceroy executive council. Was enlarged from 7(4 + 3 Indians) to 12 (4+8 Indians)members. But no member of Congress or league joined the new council..

Immediate impact of failure of August offer launching of Individual Satyagraha

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

INDIVIDUAL SATYAGRAHA, 1940

BACKGROUND

The government had taken the **adamant position** that **no constitutional advance could be made till the Congress came to an agreement with the Muslim leaders**. It issued ordinance after ordinance taking away the freedom of speech and that of the press. Towards the end of 1940, the Congress once again asked Gandhi to take command.

Individual Satyagraha is a form of **civil disobedience movement** launched by individual leaders in order to mobilize public opinion

Aim of the Satyagraha was to disapprove the British Claim of India supporting the war effort.

Why Gandhiji confined to individual Satyagraha instead of mass Satyagraha?

Due to differences and indiscipline within the Congress

Since masses were not ready. It was the step to lead to mass movement.

To give another opportunity to Government to accept Congress demand peacefully

Neither Gandhiji nor Congress wanted to hamper the British war efforts. Gandhi felt allied cause was just

The demand of Satyagrah would be freedom of speech against war through anti-war declaration. If the government did not arrest the Satyagrahi. He/she will move from one village to other and march towards Delhi, thus came to be known as **"Delhi Chalo Satyagraha"**

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

INDIVIDUAL SATYAGRAHA

3 INDIVIDUAL SATYAGRAHA SELECTED BY GANDHIJI

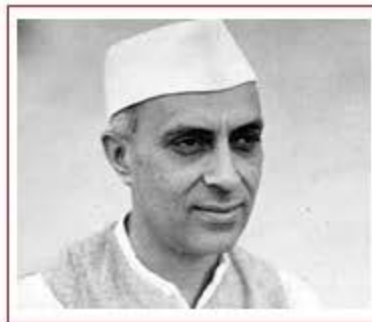
ACHARYA VINOBA BHAVE

Inaugurated the Satyagraha on 17th Oct, 1940 by delivering anti-war speech



JAWAHARLAL NEHRU

Gandhi during this satyagraha declared Nehru as his chosen successor



BRAHMA DATT

He was the third individual satyagrahi

Gandhi and Nehru relation was like Teacher-son relation. Though they were having different ideas in terms of religion, form of government, economic policy, still they believe in non-violence, Truth, Satyagrah and peaceful protest. Gandhiji even trust Nehru more than his son.

They all were arrested under the Defence of India Act

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

INDIVIDUAL SATYAGRAHA

SUSPENSION OF INDIVIDUAL SATYAGRAHA

17th OCT, 1940

Inaugurated the Satyagraha on 17th Oct, 1940 by delivering anti-war speech

17th DEC, 1940

Gandhi suspended the movement due to little enthusiasm it created.

5th JAN, 1941

Campaign was started again, In the second phase, more than 20,000 people were arrested.

DEC, 1941

Congress working committee finally decided to suspend the movement

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

CRIPPS MISSION

MAR-APR, 1942

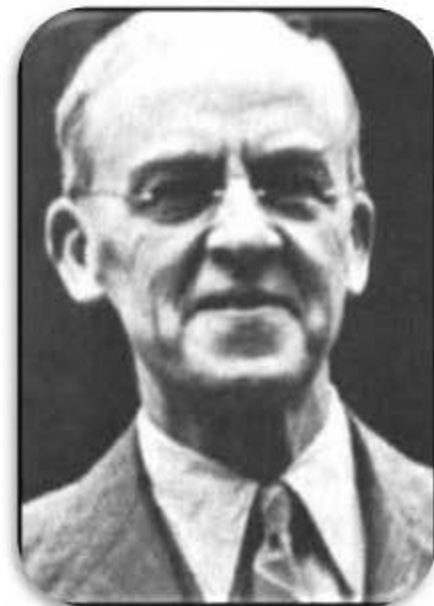
REASONS

BACKGROUND SCENCE

As World War II situation worsened after German invasion of Russia, President of USA, China and leaders of British labor Party put pressure on the then PM Winston Churchill to seek the active cooperation of Indians in war.

FOLLOW-UP STEPS

A mission headed by Sir Stafford Cripps (members of British war Cabinet) was sent to India with the Constitutional proposal to seek Indian support for war

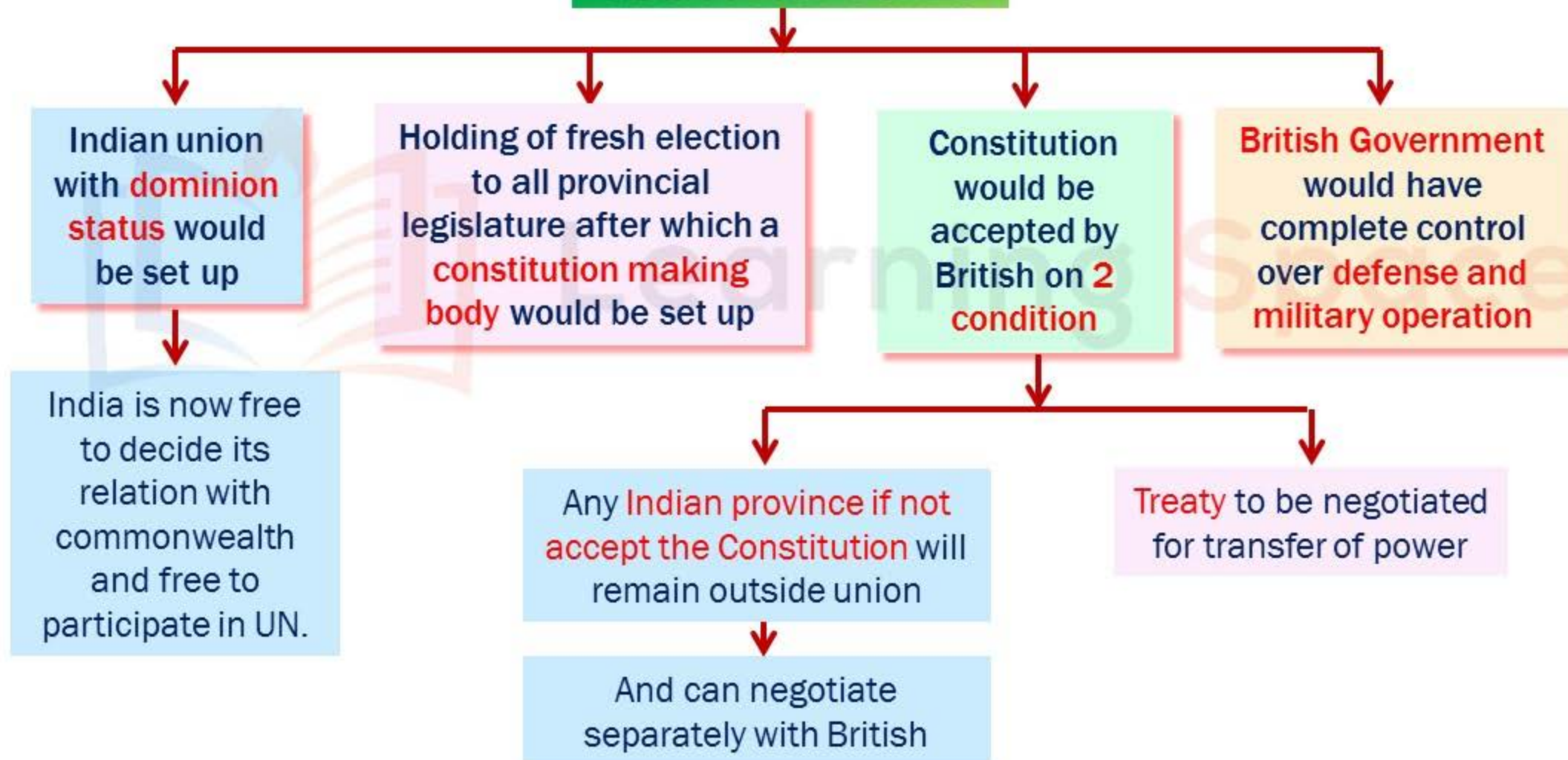


STAFFORD CRIPPS

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

CRIPPS MISSION

MAIN PROPOSALS



Jawaharlal Nehru and Maulana Azad were official negotiator of Congress

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

CRIPPS MISSION

EVALUATION

Free India could withdraw from the Commonwealth.

The making of the constitution was to be solely in Indian hands now (and not 'mainly' in Indian hands as proposed by august offer)

A concrete plan was provided for the constituent assembly.

Option was available to any province to have a separate constitution—a blueprint for India's partition.

Indians were allowed a large share in the administration in the interim period.

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

CRIPPS MISSION

REACTIONS ON CRIPPS MISSION

CONGRESS - REJECTED



- ✓ CWC stated that it would not be satisfied with mere promise for future but with only realization of freedom
- ✓ Offer of dominion states instead of complete independence
- ✓ British refusal to accept the demand for immediate transfer of effective power to Indian
- ✓ Objected the composition of Constitution making body (Nomination from princely states rather than election)
- ✓ Retention of Governor General Supremacy

GANDHI - REJECTED



- ✓ The provision of having a separate Constitution for unwilling provinces was like a invitation to Muslim league to create Pakistan.
- ✓ Gandhiji termed Cripps proposal as "Post dated cheque drawn on a failing bank"

MUSLIM LEAGUE - REJECTED



- ✓ No clear cut acceptance for demand of Pakistan.
- ✓ Criticized the idea of single Indian Union.
- ✓ Did not recognize separate electorate for Constitution making body

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

CRIPPS MISSION

REACTIONS ON CRIPPS MISSION

DEPRESSED CLASSES, SIKHS, INDIAN CHRISTIANS AND ANGLO INDIANS

- ✓ Demanded **more safeguard** for their communities.
- ✓ Thought that partition would leave them at the mercy of caste Hindus

LIBERALS

Considered **secession** proposal against unity and security of India.



HINDU MAHASABHA

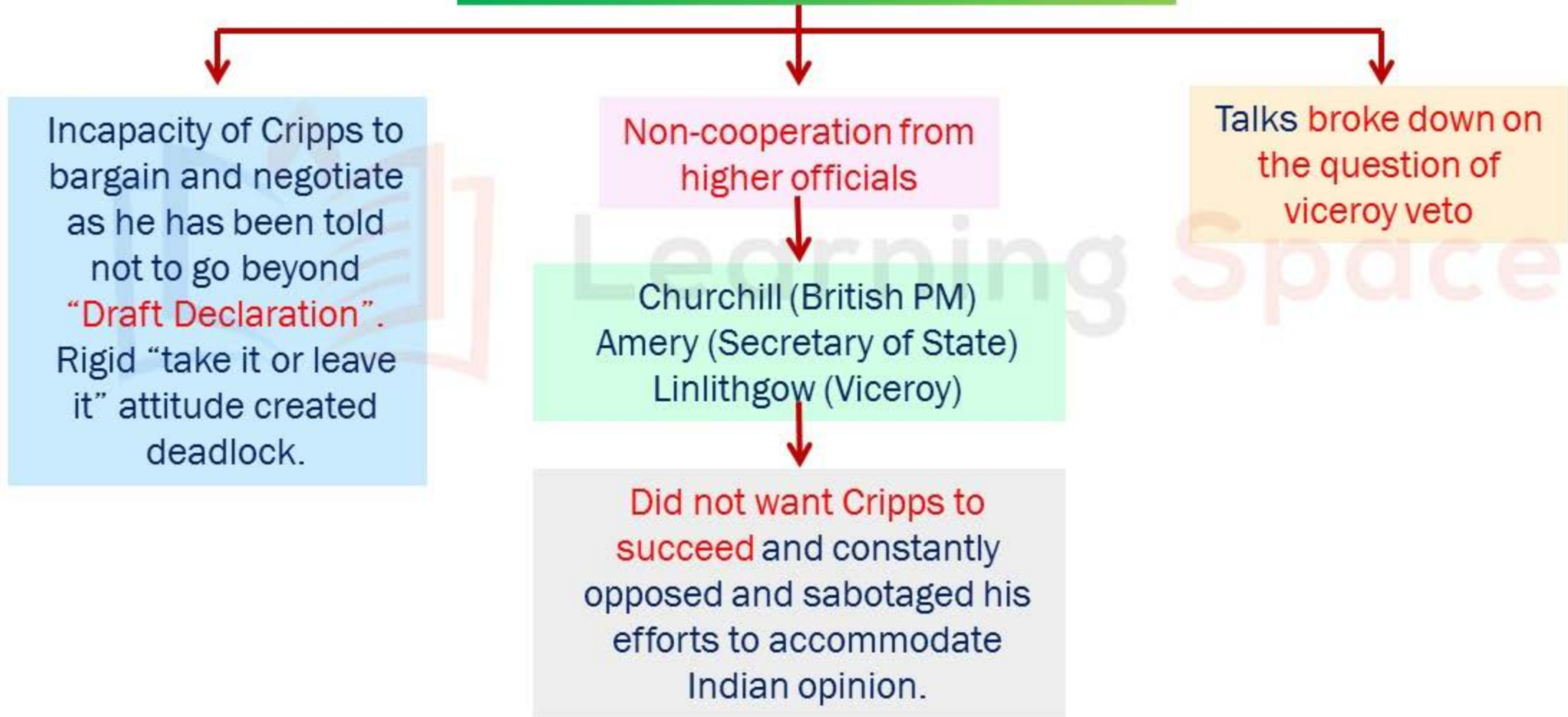
Criticized the **basis of right** to secede.



EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

CRIPPS MISSION

WHY CRIPPS MISSION FAILED?



Stafford Cripps returned home in middle leaving behind frustrated and embittered Indians.

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

BACKGROUND SCENE

- 1) Failure of Cripps Mission
- 2) Defeat of British by Japanese
- 3) Arrival of Japanese armies at Indian Border
- 4) Steeply rising inflation
- 5) Acute shortage of foodstuffs due to war
- 6) Arrogant behavior of foreign soldiers stationed in India

JULY 1942

AICC SPECIAL MEETING AT WARDHA

Criticized the
policy of British
Government on
war front

Accepted the
idea of struggle

Authorized
Gandhi to take
charge of non-
violent mass
movement

These resolution generally referred to as "Quit India Resolution" proposed by Jawaharlal Nehru and seconded Sardar Patel

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

8, Aug, 1942

AICC MEETING AT GOWALIA
TANK IN BOMBAY

This place is now called as
“AUGUST KRANTI MAIDAN”

Ratified “QUIT INDIA RESOLUTION” or
WARDHA RESOLUTION

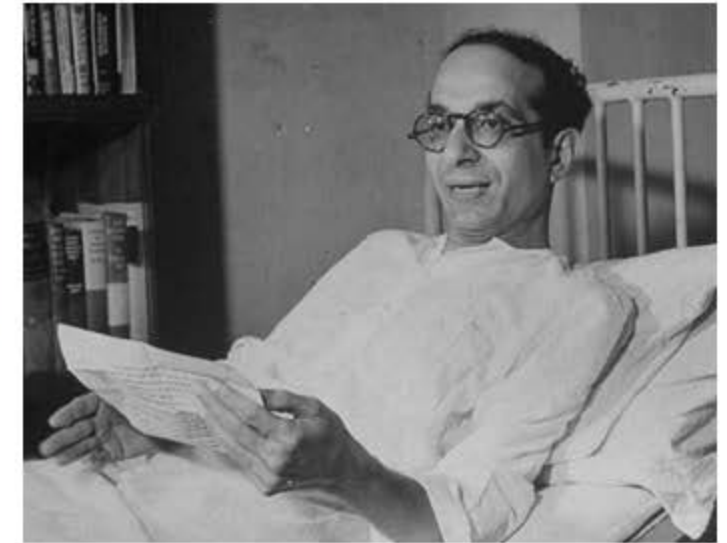
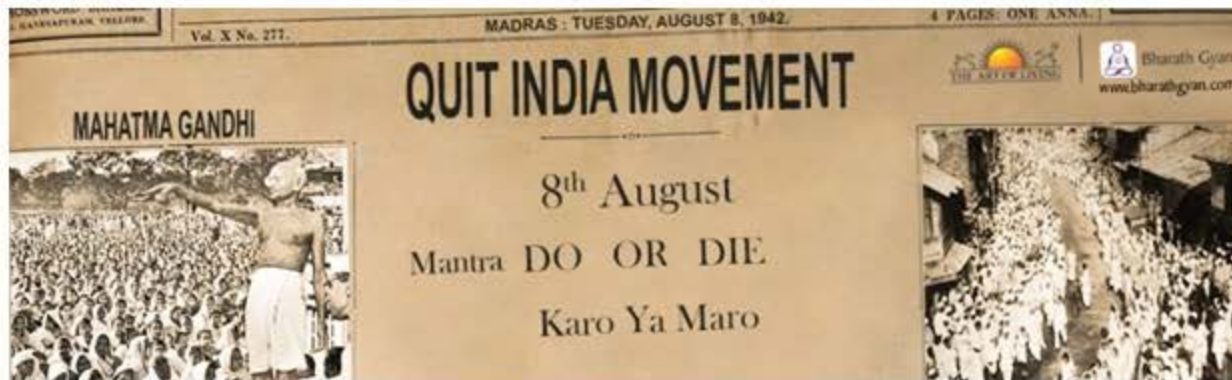
“Quit India slogan” given by
Yusuf Meherally

Resolved to

Demanded an
immediate end to
British Rule

End all types of
fascism and
imperialism

Sanction a civil
Disobedience
movement



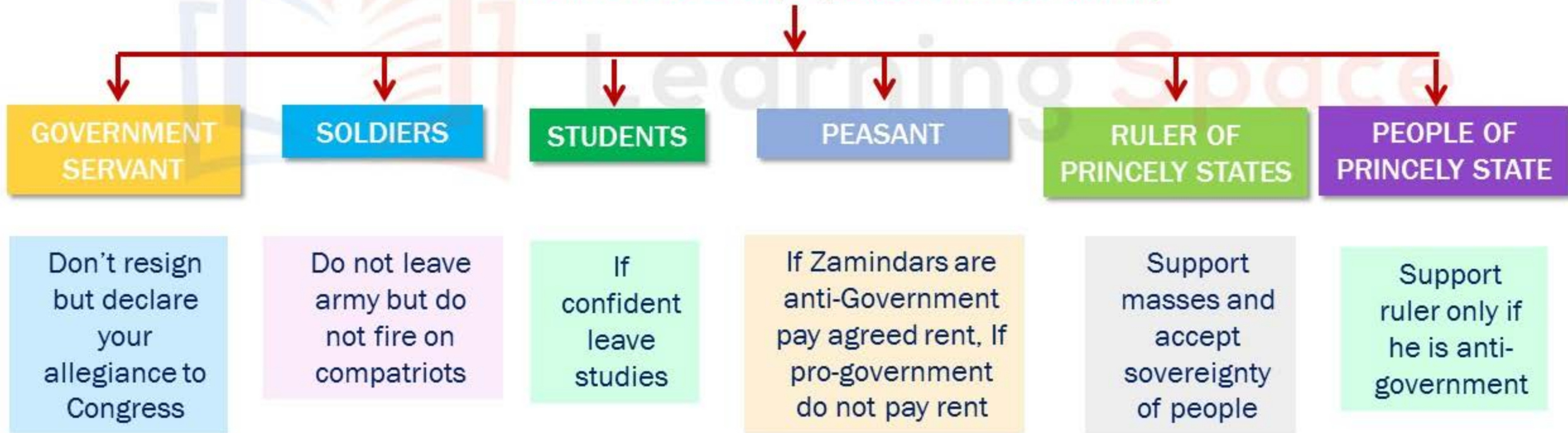
EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

8th Aug, 1942

Gandhi at Gowalia Tank meeting issued directions to various sections of society

Gandhi gave the famous "do or die" speech . Free India or die in the attempt; we shall not live to see the perpetuation of our slavery



EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

COURSE OF THE MOVEMENT

9th AUG, 1942

Police arrested Gandhi and other eminent Congress leaders



Arrest of leaders led to spontaneous outburst of mass anger. People came to streets protesting against it.



The movement thereafter became leaderless and directionless. People became rebellious.



Soon after movement lost its original character and merged itself into revolutionary / terrorist movement.

9th -13th AUG, 1942

There was widespread disturbance in Bombay, Ahmedabad, Poona, Delhi etc.



Events of these four days are known as "Great August uprising".

The movement proved to be a metaphor. It was launched as a non-violent movement but there was widespread violence. It was launched in leadership of Gandhi but Gandhi could not lead it because he along with other key leaders was put behind bars. Further, it was not planned and spread spontaneously.

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

UNDERGROUND ACTIVITY

WHY

To keep up the morale by providing command and guidance to distribute arms and ammunition

PARTICIPANTS

Socialists, Forward bloc members, Gandhi Asharamites, Revolutionary Nationalist and Local organization

LEADERS

Ram Manohar Lohia, J.P. Narayan, Aruna Asaf Ali, **Usha Mehta (Underground radio in Bombay)**, Biju Patnaik, Chhotubhai Puranik, Achyut Patwardhan, Sucheta Kripalani, R.P. Goenka

Subhash Chandra Bose described the movement “Non Violent Guerilla Warfare”.

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

PARALLEL GOVERNMENT

SATARA, (MAHARASHTRA)

- Mid 1943 – 1945
- “Prati Sarkar” with Nana Patil as its head.
- Guerilla type of struggle, raiding taluk treasuries
- Village libraries established.
- Nyayadan Mandals
- Organizing Gandhi marriages.

TAMLUK (BENGAL)

- Dec, 1942–Sep, 1944
- “Tamralipti Jatiya Sarkar” under the leadership of Satish Chandra Samanta.
- Undertook cyclone relief, social works, organized armed Vidyut Vahini

BALIA, (EASTERN UP)

Parallel Government ran for a week under Chittu Pandey

TALCHER, (ODISHA)

- Parallel government under Lakshman nayak.
- Established “Swaraj”

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

SUPPRESSION OF QIM

GOVERNMENT ACTION

- ✓ Revolutionary movement ordinance
- ✓ Arrest and detention
- ✓ Police firing, lathi charge
- ✓ Burning of Congress office
- ✓ Used Air planes to Gun people
- ✓ Flogging, Imprisonment
- ✓ Press restriction
- ✓ Rebellious villages – Fined heavily

More man 10,000 people killed

*To condemn atrocities, brutalities,
inhumane activities of British*

GANDHI'S UNDERTOOK

Fast on 10, Feb, 1943 for 21 days
in Aga Khan Palace Jail



During QIM – Gandhiji Personal Secretary – Mahadeo Desai, and Wife- Kasturiba died.
K.G. Mashruwalla took over as Editor of “Harijan” after Gandhiji Arrest.

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

SUPPRESSION OF QIM

REACTION OVER GANDHI FAST

RESPONSE

- ✓ International media, British Communist Party demanded his release
- ✓ 3 Indian members of viceroy executive council resigned.
- ✓ **Native state of Aundh** near Pune which got the **constitution of state (November declaration)** drafted by Gandhiji provided invaluable support to “Prati Sarkar” activists.

OUTCOME

- ✓ Public morale was raised
- ✓ Anti-British feeling heightened
- ✓ Governments high handedness was exposed

1944 – GANDHI WAS RELEASED, QIM WAS WITHDRAWN

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

1st PHASES

AUG 9TH -15TH

- ✓ Massive and violent
- ✓ But quickly suppressed
- ✓ Was predominantly urban in nature
- ✓ Hartal, strikes and clashes with police and army in most of the cities

2nd PHASES

AUG 15TH -SEP 30TH

- ✓ Focus being shifted to countryside
- ✓ Militant students fanning out from urban centers to rural areas in order to lead peasant rebellion and destroy communications on large scale.

3rd PHASES

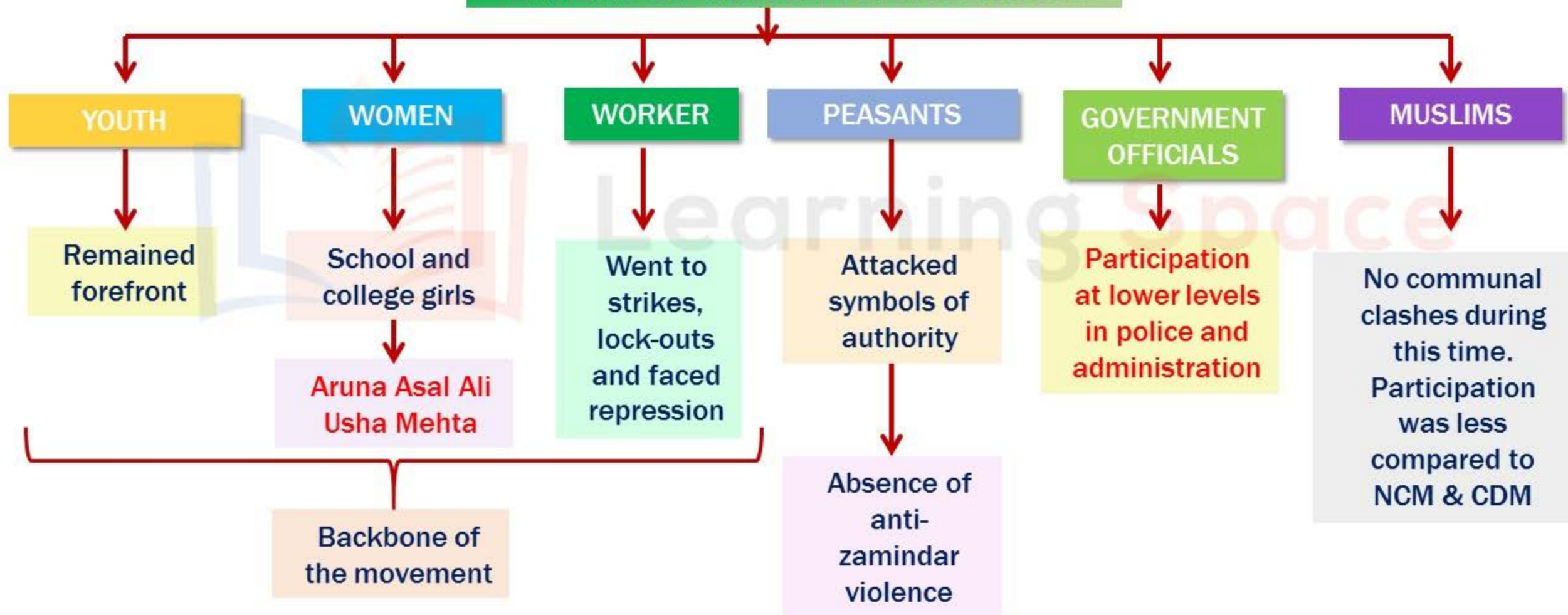
OCT - DEC, 1942

- ✓ Least formidable phase
- ✓ Characterized by terrorist activity by educated youth directed against communication, police and army installations

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

EXTENT OF MASS PARTICIPATION

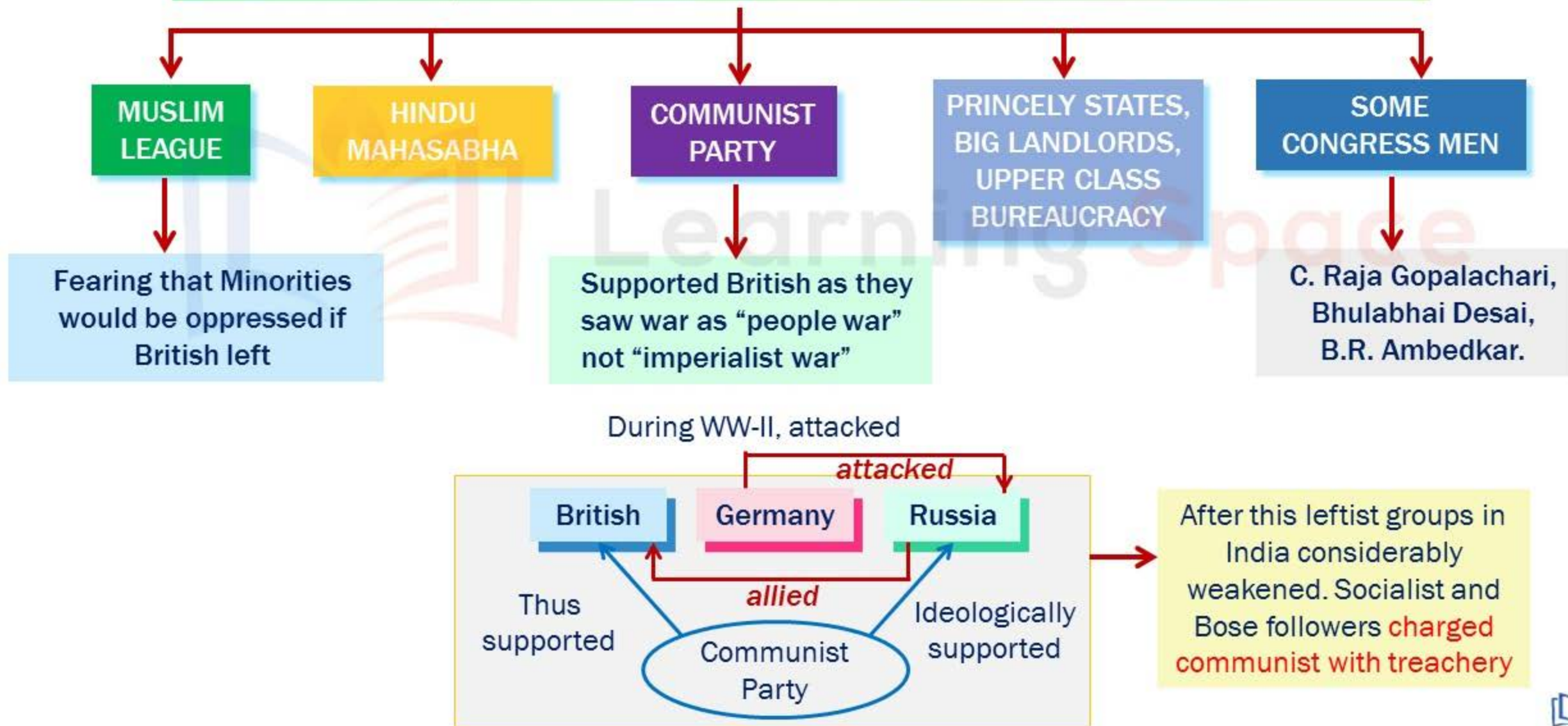


Main storm centers of the movement were in eastern United Provinces, Bihar, Midnapore, Maharashtra, Karnataka

EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

CONDEMNED, OPPOSED AND REMAINED ALOOF FROM MOVEMENT



EVENTS DURING (1940-1947)

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT, AUG 1942

SIGNIFICANCE

Nationalistic feelings influenced the government officials that **eroded the loyalty towards British.**

In this struggle, the **common people displayed unparalleled heroism and militancy.** Brutal repression by the British was not sufficient to suppress the patriotic feeling.

The element of spontaneity was higher than before.

The movement established the truth that it was no longer possible to rule India without the wishes of Indians.

Great significance was that the now demand of independence was only the ultimate goal of Indians and they are not going to compromise with it.

British now realized the advantage of negotiation rather than risking confrontation as massive and violent as this revolt.

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